



GDD 58

Money, Together

Two incomes, one life, a lot of decisions.

The Work & Money domain carried into partnership. It teaches couples to plan shared finances fairly (joint and personal accounts, big goals, the cost of a baby or a home), to keep each partner's financial independence intact, especially women's, and the warning every adult needs: financial control, allowances, cut-offs, seizing a salary or stridhan, is recognised economic abuse, not a sensible division of labour. Open, planned, both-independent, control-free. Seven mechanics, 24 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Plan it openly. Keep it fair.

Money, Together carries the Work & Money domain into shared adult life. It covers planning shared finances fairly (joint versus separate accounts, big goals, a baby's cost), keeping each partner's financial independence intact, and the warning every adult needs: financial control is a recognised form of abuse, not a sensible division of labour. It centres women's financial autonomy without being anti-anyone, draws a clear line where fair money becomes economic control, and routes that to Respect at Home (g56) and help. New v2 build, the Work & Money thread carried from Money & Independence (g48) into partnership.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g58 · money-together (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 7 · 22 → first child · adult / honest / even-handed
Thread / topics	C · Feelings & Life Skills (Work & Money) · UNESCO 5.2, 2.2
Prerequisite / builds on	g57 · builds on g48 (Money & Independence) · pairs with g55, g56
Gating	Open · independence-centred; control named as abuse
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the money-together game.

84 scenarios	7 mechanics	19 myth-flips	24 choice & voice	0% binary taps
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Open, planned, both-independent, control-free. Two incomes and one life take a lot of decisions, and the couples who talk money openly fight about it least. Fair money is built, not inherited: joint plus personal accounts, shared goals, both partners knowing the finances, and neither needing permission for ordinary spending. Earning more isn't a bigger vote, a homemaker's unpaid work is real economic value, and there's a hard line: controlling a partner's money, through allowances, cut-offs or seizing a salary or stridhan, is economic abuse under the PWDVA 2005, routing to Respect at Home (g56) and help.

Two incomes, one fair life.

From the Chapter 7 personas (22 onward). Adults whose money is entangled with a partner, in-laws and "log kya kahenge", who need to plan fairly, keep their own footing, and tell fair sharing from financial control, the spine here being transparency over control and the homemaker's real value.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Pooja (earns, no say)	Money decisions that stop "flowing through the men".	strike-rewrite + sort : fair, not gendered.
Karthik (the partner)	To plan openly and split fairly as a team.	branch + role-play : the money talk.
Reshma (financial control)	To name economic abuse and find help and footing.	sort + branch : control is abuse.
Sneha & Razia	Independence, stridhan rights, and a calm answer to pressure.	role-play + match : stay independent.

Why this works (the evidence). Financial transparency and joint engagement, deciding, planning and budgeting together, are linked to less money stress and higher relationship satisfaction, and money is a top source of couple conflict, so open early talks are protective, not unromantic. Many couples do best with both a joint account and personal accounts, an emergency fund, and both partners knowing the money. Each partner's independence matters, "he handles the money because he earns it" is a myth, and a homemaker's unpaid work is real economic value. And there is a clear line: controlling a partner's money, or taking their stridhan or barring their work, is economic abuse, recognised domestic violence under the PWDVA 2005.

Seven moves, led by the plan and the flip.

It's a fair-money game, so **branch** leads (choose the open, fair, both-independent move) alongside **strike-rewrite** clearing the money myths, with **sort** drawing the lines (joint vs personal, fair vs gendered, fair vs abuse); **role-play** gives the words for the money talk and the calm boundary. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE ADULT DOES	EMBODIES	N
strike-rewrite signature	Busts a money myth ("he handles it because he earns it").	Conceptual change.	19
branch (the choice) signature	Chooses the open, fair, both-independent move.	Judgement.	16
reflect	Internalises open planning, independence and the control line.	Values.	12
sort	Sorts joint vs personal; fair vs gendered; fair vs abuse.	The line.	11
match	Pairs a money tool to its job; a myth to the fair reality.	Connections.	9
spot	Spots economic abuse; the fair setup; control dressed as care.	Reading it.	9
role-play (voice)	Opens the money talk; the check-in; the calm boundary.	Voice; care.	8

24 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it engaging?

Game feel is relief and control at a loaded, often-avoided topic: the calm of a framework for the money talk, the satisfaction of designing a fair split instead of stewing over an unfair one, and the quiet strength of keeping your own footing. The "oh, we can just plan this openly" moment lands repeatedly, and the planning-sim makes a baby's cost or a home goal feel solvable. Sam is a warm adult peer; the tone is even-handed and practical, never preachy, and never financial advice.

Is it teaching?

Yes: planning shared finances fairly (accounts, goals, big costs); keeping personal financial independence within a partnership; sharing money decisions without gendered defaults and valuing unpaid home work; and recognising financial control, allowances, cut-offs, seizing a salary or stridhan, barring work, as economic abuse that routes to Respect at Home (g56) and help.

The belief it moves. From "money talk is unromantic; he handles it because he earns it; a homemaker has no claim; the top earner decides; controlling the money is just being head of the family" → "open money talk is care; both partners have a say and a stake; unpaid work has real value; decisions are shared; and controlling a partner's money is economic abuse, not headship."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the money-talk → plan-together → stay-independent → fair-not-gendered → control-is-abuse → tools arc, India-grounded and even-handed. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
The money talk	14	strike-rewrite, branch, sort	Open, early, honest; incomes, debts, goals.
Plan together	14	strike-rewrite, branch, sort	Joint + personal; goals; baby/home; emergency fund.
Stay independent	14	strike-rewrite, branch, match	Own footing; homemaker's value; both literate.
Fair, not gendered	14	strike-rewrite, sort, match	Money isn't a man's job; the earner isn't the boss.
Control is abuse	14	strike-rewrite, sort, branch	Economic abuse; PWDVA 2005; stridhan; route to g56.
Tools & help	14	branch, match, reflect	The money talk, both-accounts, check-in, help routes.

The 'he earns it' flip + the economic-abuse flip, verbatim.

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flip: "He handles the money because he earns it."
UN -> "He handles the money because he earns it."
RE -> "Earning more doesn't grant control over a shared life's money;
      both partners have a say and a stake."

flip: "Economic abuse isn't real domestic violence because no one gets hit."
UN -> "Economic abuse isn't real DV because no one gets hit."
RE -> "Indian law recognises economic abuse, denying money, assets or
      access, as domestic violence under the PWDVA 2005."
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Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 58 Money Together — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Talking money early is unromantic.	Open, early money talks are care, and they prevent most money fights.	Talk is care.
If we love each other, we'll never fight about money.	Love doesn't auto-solve finances; open communication does.	Love isn't enough.
He handles the money because he earns it.	Earning more isn't control; both partners have a say and a stake.	Earning isn't control.
A homemaker has no real claim on the money.	Unpaid home and care work is real economic value; her claim is equal.	Homemaker's value.
Managing money is a man's job.	Financial skill is learned, not gendered; both partners should have it.	Not gendered.
Whoever earns more gets the final say.	Shared-life money decisions are shared; income is not a bigger vote.	Shared decisions.
Controlling all the money is just being head of the family.	Controlling a partner's access to money is economic abuse.	Control is abuse.
Economic abuse isn't real DV because no one gets hit.	Economic abuse is recognised domestic violence under the PWDVA 2005.	Recognised DV.

The micro-loop.

1. **Surface.** Sam (adult peer) surfaces a real moment, an unequal split, a "he handles it", a baby's cost, a partner cut off from money.
2. **Choose or voice.** The adult chooses the open, fair, both-independent move (branch), or finds the words (role-play).
3. **The flip.** UN busts a money myth; RE writes the open, fair truth.
4. **Plan & protect.** Joint plus personal accounts, shared goals, both staying literate and independent.
5. **Line & help.** Tell fair money from control; economic abuse routes to Respect at Home (g56) and help.
6. **Sticker.** The Money, Together badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **open money talk** and the **fair-split plan**. It carries Money & Independence (g48) into shared life, pairs with Equal Partners (g55) for the shared load, and guards against the financial control covered in Respect at Home (g56).

Independence-centred; control named as abuse.

- **Centres financial independence, especially women's.** The node protects each partner's access, literacy and footing, and never shames a homemaker or a lower earner.
- **Even-handed.** Fair money is for both partners; the framing is never anti-men, and it never shames any current arrangement, while naming where money is gendered.
- **A clear fair-vs-abuse line.** Open planning and budgeting are healthy; tiny policed allowances, cut-offs, seizing a salary or stridhan, and barring work are named as economic abuse.
- **Economic abuse is recognised DV.** Denying money, disposing of assets including stridhan, or restricting access is economic abuse under the Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act 2005, with protection orders and monetary relief.
- **Routes to Respect at Home (g56).** Where money becomes control, the node hands off to g56 and the shared "get help" component.
- **Educational, not financial or legal advice.** Planning and legal points are general information; specifics route to a professional.
- **Access & privacy.** Self-directed, audio, offline, low-end build; no products, ads or real financial data; private by design (DPDP-aligned); expert-reviewed.

If money becomes control (India). Being denied money for basics, cut off, monitored for every rupee, having your salary or stridhan taken, or stopped from working is economic abuse, recognised domestic violence, not your fault and not your shame. Women Helpline **181** · women in distress **1091** · emergency **112** · free legal aid NALSA **15100** · and a counsellor. Stridhan is yours by law. See Respect at Home (g56).

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. money-together** equals node.game equals GameDone key equals registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; the **strike-rewrite** money-myth flip and the **branch** fair choice co-lead.
- **Even-handedness is a hard requirement.** Independence-centred, never-anti-men, never-shaming, and the clear fair-vs-abuse line are contractual; expert-reviewed.
- **Fact-checked content.** Financial-transparency-and-satisfaction research, the both-accounts model, stridhan rights, and economic abuse under the PWDVA 2005 verified this build.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 23%, 0% binary, 24 autonomy, 19 UN→RE, 6 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook.** Financial control or economic abuse route via the shared "get help" component (181 / 1091 / 112 / NALSA 15100 / counsellor) and Respect at Home (g56).
- **Tracked.** build_gate.py finalize advances g58 to v2 PASS only after order, read, score, audit and artifact gates pass.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): financial-independence-centred; even-handed and never-anti-men; never shames a homemaker or lower earner; a clear fair-vs-abuse line; economic abuse named as recognised DV; routed to g56 and help; educational, not financial or legal advice; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Open, joint money lowers conflict, so teach the talk.** Because transparency and joint financial engagement predict less money stress and more satisfaction, teaching the money talk and shared planning genuinely improves couple finances.
- **Independence is protective, so build it.** Since total financial dependence is a vulnerability and a homemaker's unpaid work has real value, helping both partners keep literacy, access and footing protects them, especially women.
- **A clear line keeps it safe.** Because controlling a partner's money is economic abuse recognised under the PWDVA 2005, naming the line plainly and routing those cases to g56 and help is what makes the practical money guidance honest and safe.

Sources: UNESCO ITGSE Key Concepts 5 (skills, decision-making) and 2 (values, rights, culture); financial-transparency and marital-satisfaction research (joint engagement and openness predict less money stress and higher satisfaction); the both-accounts model (joint for shared costs, personal for autonomy) and emergency-fund practice; UN Women on women's economic empowerment and financial autonomy; stridhan as a woman's own property; and economic abuse under India's Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act 2005 (deprivation of resources, disposal of assets including stridhan, and restricted access), with help routes (Women Helpline 181, women-in-distress 1091, emergency 112, NALSA legal aid 15100, and counsellors). Even-handed and independence-centred, with a clear fair-vs-abuse line; educational, not financial or legal advice. Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 58 games now v2. Next by order: If, When & Whether (g59).